

Light bulb

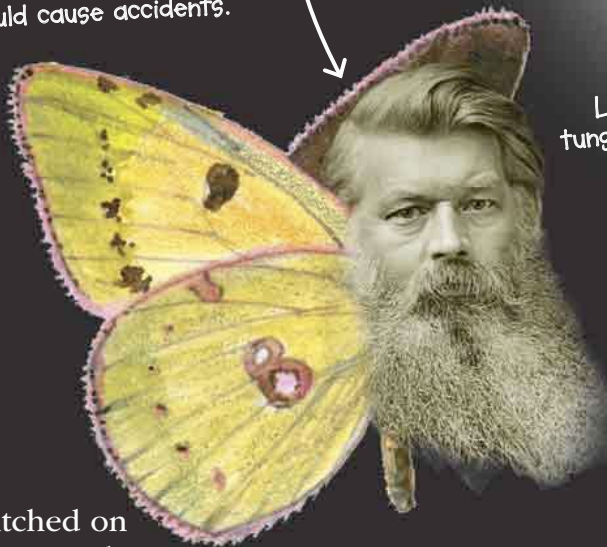
The invention that LIT UP the world

From the beginning of the dimly lit 1800s, inventors groped around for ways to turn electricity into light.



Davy's lamp was designed to help miners, as an alternative to fire, which could cause accidents.

Joseph Swan's house in Gateshead, England, was the first to be lit by a light bulb.



Longer-lasting tungsten filaments were invented in 1910.

Switching on

The first **electric light** was switched on by Humphry Davy when he connected two charcoal rods to a battery in 1809. Davy's light was bright, but it didn't last long. It showed that **some materials glow** when electricity passes through them, but the lights often caught fire. Fellow Englishman Joseph Swan experimented with removing the **AIR** from the bulb in the 1870s to stop this, but ran into other problems.

Did you know?

The first buildings with electric light had warning notices in them advising people not to light the bulbs with a match.

It paved the way for...



The first **CAR HEADLIGHTS** used oil, but much safer **ELECTRIC** ones were invented in 1898.

Neon lights, which contain the gas **NEON**, were invented by Frenchman **GEORGES CLAUDE** in 1910.

